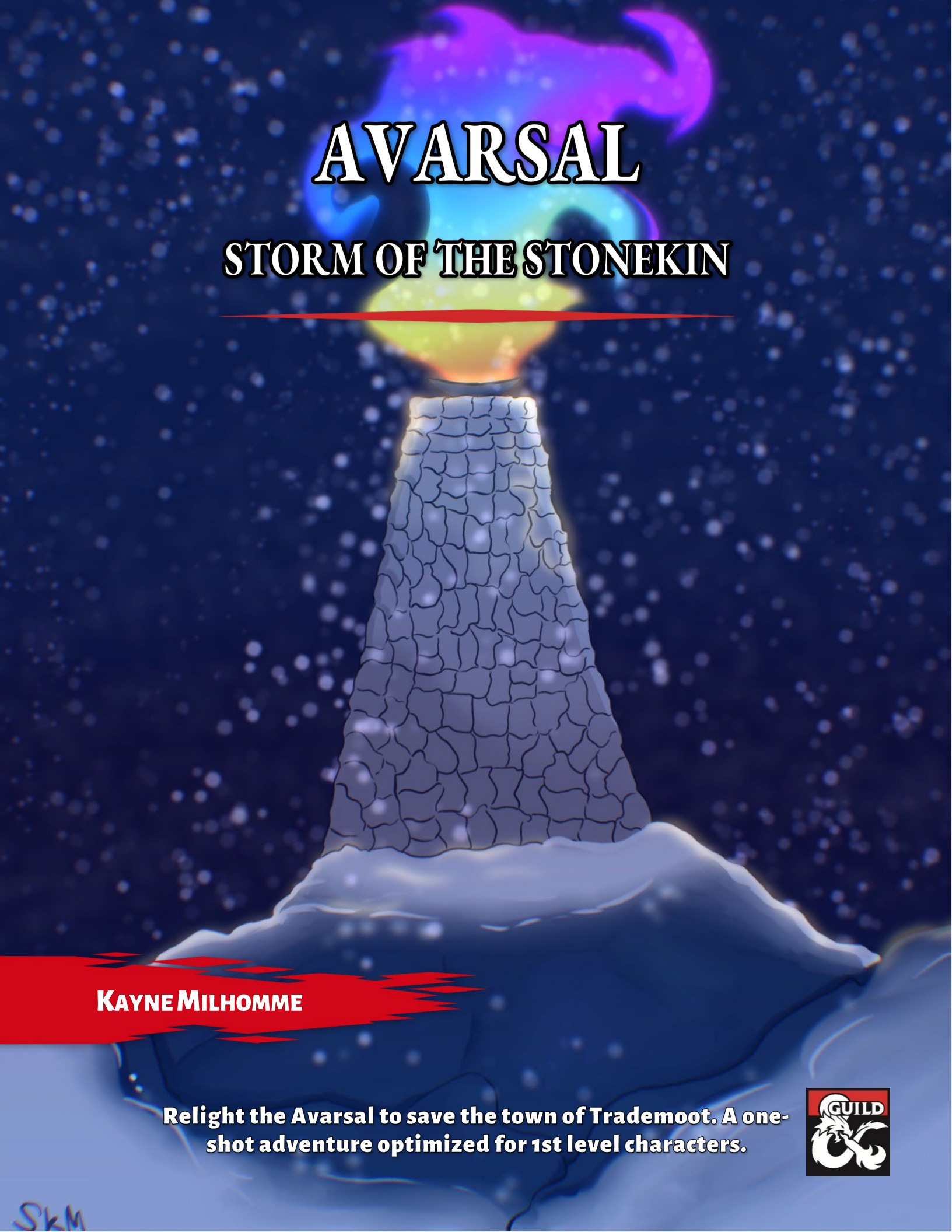
AVARSAL

STORM OF THE STONEKIN



KAYNE MILHOMME

Relight the Avarsal to save the town of Trademoot. A one-shot adventure optimized for 1st level characters.

GUILD

Credits

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Table of Contents

Credits 1

Table of Contents 2

Introduction 3

History 3

Synopsis 3

Chapter 1 - Trademoot 4

T1-Shepherd's Run 4

T2-Old Town 4

T3-Ruined Rune Inn 4

T4-Market Square 4

T5-Chancery 4

T6-Wool Mills 4

T7-Horse Traders 4

Chapter 2 – Into the Mountains 6

Deepwound Pass 6

Copper Mine 7

C1-Entrance (Wolf Lair) 9

C2-Furnace Room 9

C3- Priest's Quarters 9

C4- Residences 9

C5- Temple of Dumathoin 9

C6-Upper Mine 9

C7-The Maw (Exit) 9

C8-Lower Mine 10

C9-The Five Alcoves 10

Chapter 3 – The Avarsal 10

A1- Crossing 11

A2- Orc Guards 12

A3- Stonekin Pass 12

A4- The Avarsal Tower 12

A5- Ledge 14

Conclusion 14

The Avarsal is relit 14

The avarsal is not relit 14

Rewards/XP 14

Monsters & NPCs 14

Magic Items 15

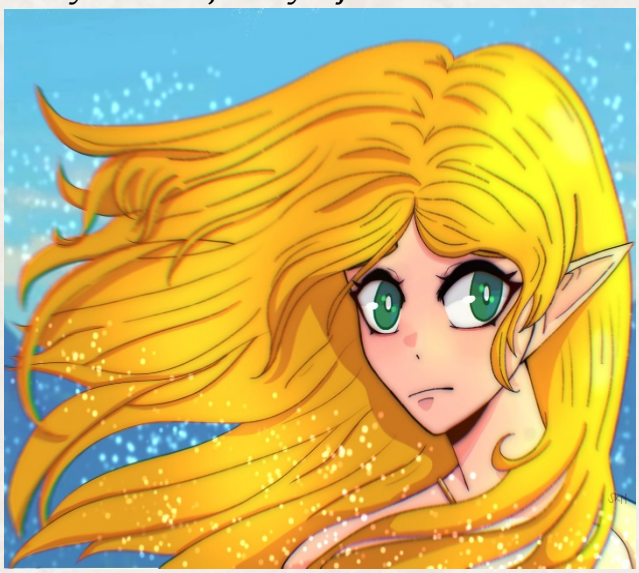
Introduction

The Avarsal is a short adventure that can be completed in one 4-hour session. It is designed for 1st level characters.

The adventure is written for any mountainous region in the Forgotten Realms setting, but is easily transferable to other worlds.

For encounters, refer to the **Monster's Manual** for monster stat blocks unless otherwise indicated.

Aelwyn Avarsal, martyr of Helm



History

Two centuries ago a contingent of dwarves from the Rune clan was assigned to mine copper. Unhappy with their lot (as much as dwarves love their fine copper kettles and pots, they would have rather been mining iron ore for arms and armor), they started a settlement at the base of the mountains near the mine and called it the Ruined Rune. An unexpected discovery of palladium may have changed their fortunes, but it was not even a year before they were driven away by mountain orcs known as the Stonekin.

A century later **Aelwyn Avarsal**, an elven high priest of **Helm**, founded the temple of Dawn's Renewal at the site of the Ruined Rune. As with the dwarves, the Stonekin orcs spilled from the highest reaches of the mountains to destroy the guardians, smashing the temple to ruins. Aelwyn, the lone survivor, called upon Helm in her moment of need and was heard. A searing light burst from her twin hammers, blinding much of the enemy force. Overcome with furor, Aelwyn waded into the fray, defeating the orc leader and countless other enemies before finally being overwhelmed. When Aelwyn died Helm sent her spirit into the hammers and the light remained, permanently blinding and stunning the Stonekin orcs and causing them to flee. The victory, witnessed by nomads and shared over the years, is now chronicled as The Battle of Helm's Light.

Some fifty years later the ruins of Dawn's Renewal were settled by gnome artificers (glass specialists) seeking the rumored palladium in the old dwarven mine to toughen their glass products. The artificers discovered Aelwyn's twin hammers buried in the temple ruins and built a contraption that magnified the holy light. Aware of the light's benefit from local tales, the gnomes secured the contraption atop an old dwarven watchtower in the mountains, and with Helm's light burning bright into the sky the Stonekin orcs stayed hidden in the mountains. The sentinel beacon atop the tower is now known as the Avarsal.

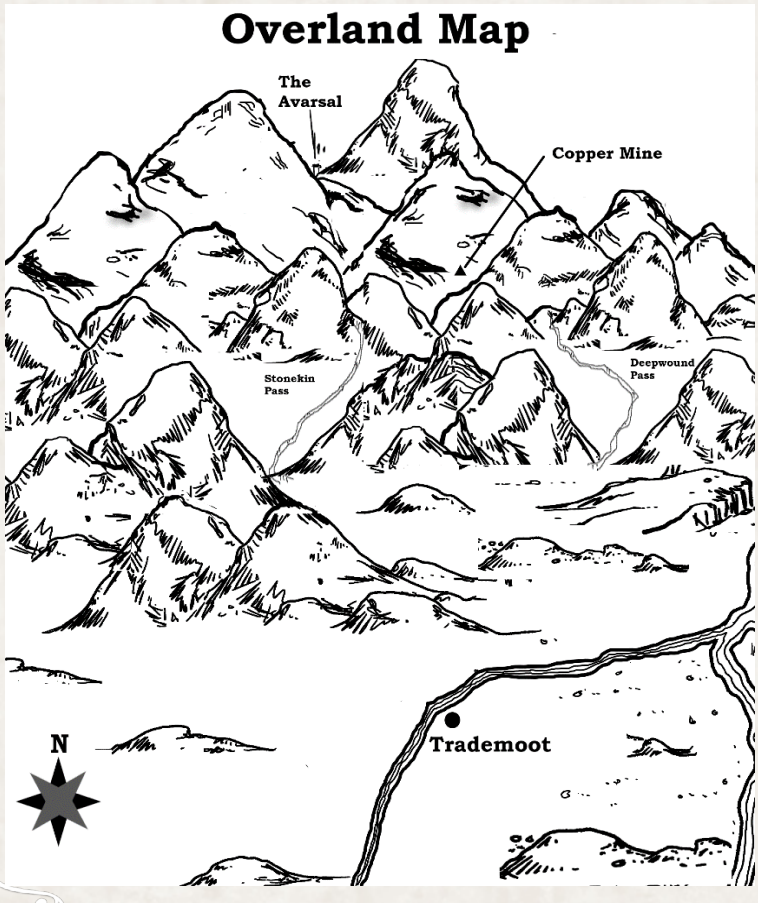
Despite their new innovation, the gnomes soon gathered the palladium they needed and moved on from the settlement. Under the protection of the Avarsal, new arrivals expanded the settlement into the town of Trademoot which became renowned for horse trading and wool production. As long as the light burned from the Avarsal, Trademoot would continue in peace and prosperity.

Synopsis

The town of Trademoot is in danger. For fifty years, the Avarsal's light has shone from the mountains, protecting the town from attack by the **Stonekin orcs**.

But recently and without warning the light has extinguished, leaving the inhabitants of Trademoot confused and fearful. And with good reason, for the Stonekin orcs have noticed the light's absence. With its presence gone from the sky, the orcs are no longer fearful of **Avarsal's Bane** (detailed in the Magic Items section under Hammers of Helm) and have begun preparations for an assault.

Unbeknownst to the inhabitants of Trademoot, the Avarsal has failed because a gnome artificer, **Erwen Erwell**, begrudged at being spurned by **Blue-Eyed Sandy**, traveled to the Avarsal with revenge in mind. There he ordered



Palladium, his **Glass Construct**, to remove the glowing hammers from the Avarsal, dousing the magic light.

Not all went to plan for Erwen, however. When Palladium touched the hammers, Aelwyn Avarsal's spirit transferred from the hammers to the construct, taking control. When she refused to give up the hammers, Erwen resorted to force, and she quickly dispatched him.

The Trademoot council prioritized the need for an investigation into the circumstances of the Avarsal's light being dowsed, but the sighting of orcs along Stonekin Pass and the well-known treacherous conditions of Deepwound Pass left the volunteer queue empty. This left only one option for the Trademoot Council: hire adventurers.

Adventure Hooks

Enter the adventurers. The Trademoot Council is desperate to have the Avarsal relit and will pay a handsome reward for successful completion of the job.

The adventurers can be drawn to Trademoot by happenstance, business, or by viewing the Avarsal's sudden extinguishing. For the latter option, the light can be seen from great distances.

Whatever the reason, due to the fact that the town is currently on alert, the presence of the adventurers should be discovered almost immediately. If they inquire about the Avarsal, they will be pointed to the Chancery. Otherwise, they will be summoned to the Chancery to discuss being hired to investigate the Avarsal.

Chapter 1 - Trademoot

Read-Aloud Text

Huddled under the shadow of ominous mountains, the village of Trademoot faces its perils from behind wind-battered palisades and stone-hunched edifices.

It is a tenuous and lonely existence here between the edge of the tundra and the mountains, but it is lucrative for the frontier folk who call it 'home.' Noteworthy among them are the town's famous horse-breeders and wool-textilers, whose herds and flocks dot the landscape.

T1-Shepherd's Run

A long stretch of uncultivated ryegrass and dried mud along the bank of Cold River, trampled and matted by the many flocks of sheep that spend twilight to morning curled up in rest here. The pair of buildings adjacent are a poor-weather barn and a family residence.

Shepherd's Run has the distinct scent of fresh-cut grass and loamy soil-after-a-storm. During the day, bleating can be heard across the river in the fields of orchard grass and white clover where the sheep are herded. The wool produced by the sheep of Trademoot is highly sought after.

T2-Old Town

Nestled behind the palisade walls, Old Town is a cluster of small-inhabitant stone homes dating back to some of the early residents, artificer gnomes. Fashioned from striated-limestone, these buildings have a brighter sheen than the more prevalent gray slate structures in the rest of town.

T3-Ruined Rune Inn

Cheap and bawdy, the Ruined Rune draws a hardened, fire-bellied crowd looking for hearth and drink after a long day's labor. The inn is most famous for its excellent river trout dinner, homebrewed Avarsal Ale, and music.

The Inn is the oldest establishment in Trademoot, dating back to the Ruined Rune dwarves, somehow surviving both orc invasions. Some think it is due to the Ruined Rune sigil in the basement. In fact, unbeknownst to anyone in Trademoot, the sigil is a Teleportation Circle (see Trademoot Features for more information)

The inn is owned and operated by Blue-Eyed Sandy, a 3rd level female human bard. Many residents are or were besotted with her, including the late Erwen Erwell.

T4-Market Square

The market is a spacious cobblestone area where, once a ten-day, visiting tundra nomads, mountain barbarians and foresters set up their wares from tents and wagons. The imported goods include wild game, dried fish, pipe weed, firewood, and furs.

T5-Chancery

A one-story, somewhat disheveled office, the Chancery acts as the administration center and council chamber for Trademoot. It is where all town deeds and manners of business are signed and settled, including the meeting with Lylwyn Shine and the council to discuss the Avarsal opportunity (see the Notable NPCs sidebar on page six for more details).

T6-Wool Mills

The span of Wool Mills includes both watermills and windmills, the majority of which support the production of Trademoot's most lucrative product by preparing, spinning, and weaving wool.

Wool Mills also includes a gristmill and a stone oven.

T7-Horse Traders

The raising grounds for the flourishing horse market, the Horse Traders expanse accommodates Muglundy Farms and Sasha's, two competing interests that breed and sell horses and gear.

Each outfit also has an operating blacksmith. Muglundy Farms has a wider variety of breeds, but Sasha's are considered higher quality, as reflected in the cost.

What to Do in Trademoot

The characters can explore the various areas of town both before and/or after meeting with Lylwyn Shine and the council to discuss the Avarsal business.

Goods can be purchased in town for the going rates stipulated in Chapter 5 of the **Player's Handbook,** with the exception of woolen fare and horses. Both are of exceptional quality, and cost 15-25% more than normal.

The Old Town Glassworks is a remnant of the gnome artificers' settlement prior to Trademoot, and may provide some areas of interest for the adventurers.

Trademoot Features

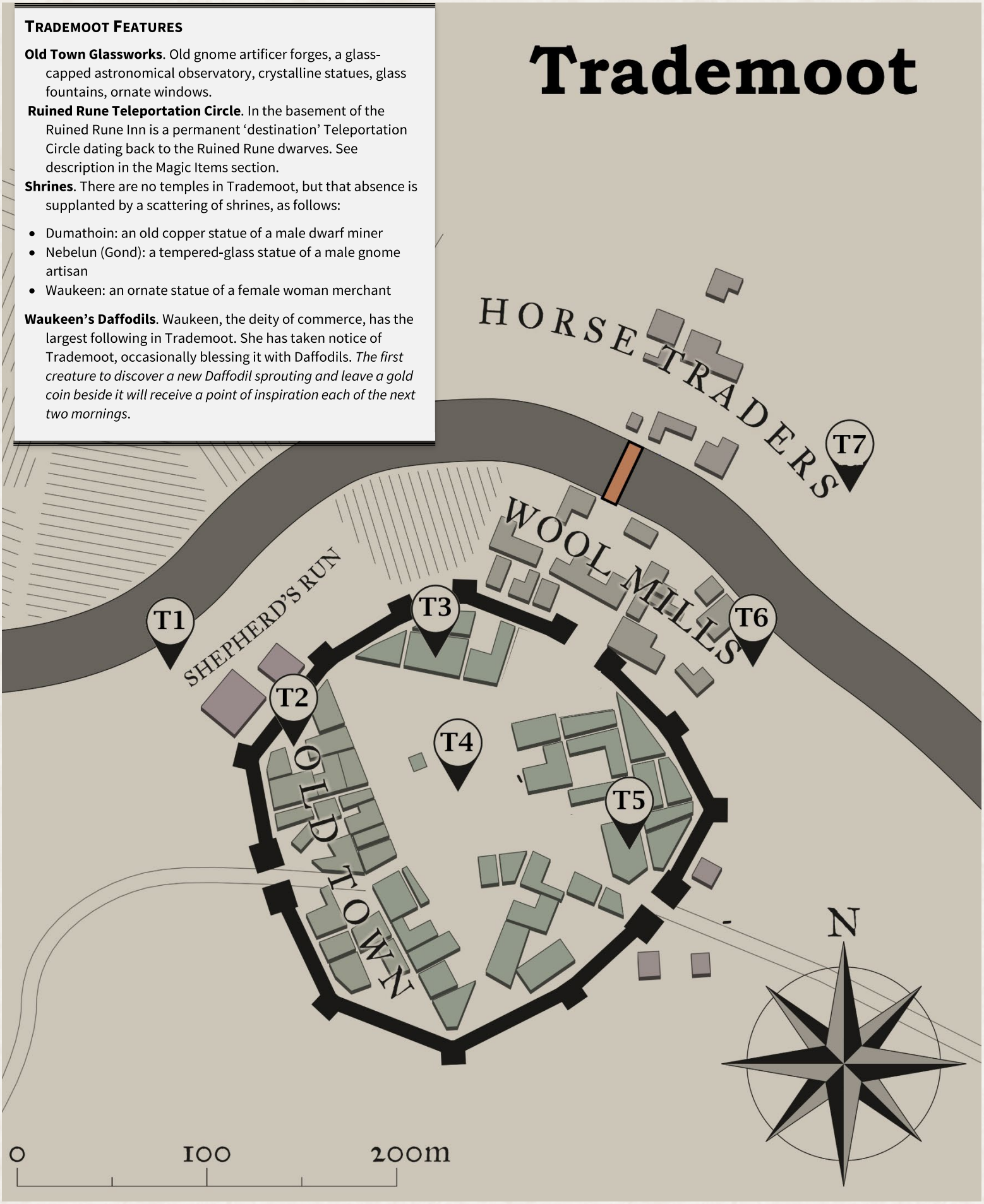
Old Town Glassworks. Old gnome artificer forges, a glass-capped astronomical observatory, crystalline statues, glass fountains, ornate windows.

Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle. In the basement of the Ruined Rune Inn is a permanent 'destination' Teleportation Circle dating back to the Ruined Rune dwarves. See description in the Magic Items section.

Shrines. There are no temples in Trademoot, but that absence is supplanted by a scattering of shrines, as follows:

- Dumathoin: an old copper statue of a male dwarf miner
- Nebelun (Gond): a tempered-glass statue of a male gnome artisan
- Waukeen: an ornate statue of a female woman merchant

Waukeen's Daffodils. Waukeen, the deity of commerce, has the largest following in Trademoot. She has taken notice of Trademoot, occasionally blessing it with Daffodils. *The first creature to discover a new Daffodil sprouting and leave a gold coin beside it will receive a point of inspiration each of the next two mornings*.



Notable NPCs in Trademoot

Blue-Eyed Sandy. Half-elf female bard, proprietor of the Ruined Rune Inn. If the PCs perform at her inn and are successful on DC 15 Charisma (Performance) check, she will show them the **Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle** on the basement floor (see Trademoot Features sidebar). She does not what it is.

Bothos. Gnome male artificer-in-training, currently looking for a new mentor, usually can be found in Old Town tinkering somewhere. If the adventurers befriend him, he will share a story about a gnome artificer losing a magic ring in the copper mine many years ago.

Chatty and Gossip. Human male laborer, usually can be found at the Ruined Rune Inn with a small mountain bluebird (Gossip) on his shoulder. The two are often conversing in a strange, chittering language. If the adventurers befriend Chatty, he will tell them that Gossip recently spotted something metallic shining on top of the Avarsal. (Gossip will not fly any closer to the Avarsal than she already has).

Harvest Hal Hunchrumpkin. Halfling male shepherd, town **guard**. Never met a nap he didn't like. If the adventurers befriend him, he will tell them that he spotted Erwen Erwell and his strange construct (that markedly resembles Blue-Eyed Sandy) heading for the mountains a few nights ago.

Lylwyn Shine. Human female **priest** of Waukeen and Light, head chair of the Trademoot Council. She has held the council chair for five years and is well respected by the populace. Use **priest** in Monster Manual for her stats, with the exception of CHA 17.

Yellowknife. Human female **scout**, council member. Expert outdoorsman, knows the surrounding wild better than anyone else.

The Council Meeting

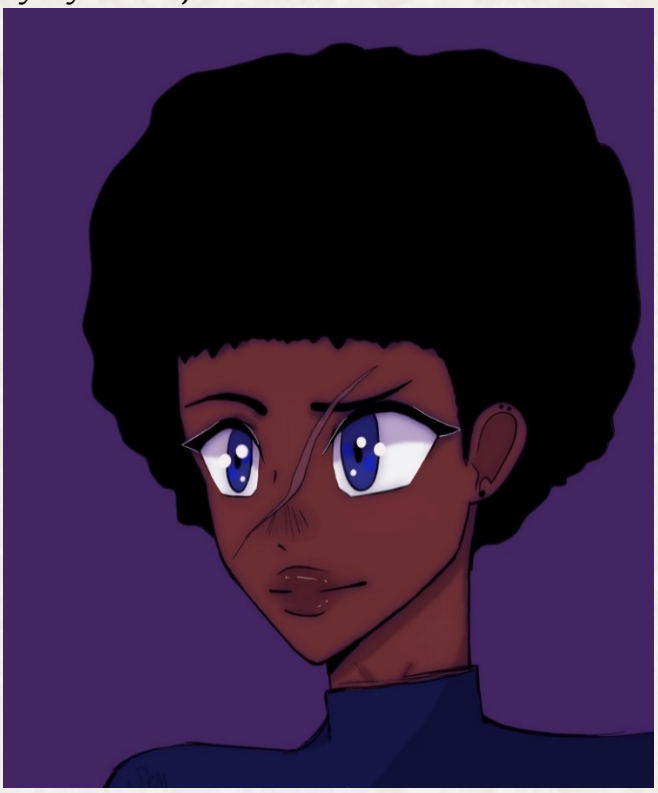
Not long after the adventurers arrive in town, they will be summoned to meet with the council. The council members present are Lylwyn Shine, Blue-Eyed Sandy, and Yellowknife (see Notable NPCs sidebar for more details).

Lylwyn Shine will be welcoming but also direct with the adventurers. Her first concern is the safety of Trademoot, and she will do whatever it takes to ensure that. She will offer the adventurers 100 gold pieces to investigate the Avarsal and return with news, and 400 additional gold pieces to relight it, 50 gp of that paid up-front. Due to the seriousness of the situation, she can be persuaded by the adventurers on a successful DC 13 Charisma (Persuasion) check to sweeten the offer by 100-200 gp, at the discretion of the DM.

Yellowknife will offer her services as a guide through Deepwound Pass to the old copper mine. If the adventurers refuse her offer, she will instead warn them of wild weather, recent wolf sightings, and 'deadfalls' (a thin layer of snow or weak slate that hides deep crevices) in the mountain pass. She will also tell the adventurers that Stonekin Pass is currently impenetrable due to orc sightings and cannot be taken.

If the adventurers ask about the Avarsal, Lylwyn Shine will share Aelwyn's legend as described in the second paragraph of the History section. She is not familiar with the artificers' role or how the Avarsal works.

Lylwyn Shine, Council Head



Chapter 2 – Into the Mountains

> **Read-Aloud Text (Winter Season)**
> The rock-strewn pass thrusts and jolts up the mountains like a deity's thunderbolt, creating a capricious maze of ice-walled dead ends, snow covered deadfalls, and other yet unknown dangers.

Stonekin Pass

The Stonekin Pass is a steep, winding route up the mountains that leads into the distant Stonekin orc territory. Orcs have been sighted in the pass of late in frightening numbers.

Currently the pass is impenetrable due to its reclamation by the Stonekin orcs. The orcs are positioned with ranged weapons, cover, and high ground. This pass is not intended to be used by the adventurers, but provides a route for the threatening orc invasion.

Deepwound Pass

The way to the Avarsal starts with Deepwound Pass. The pass is considered Difficult Terrain and is too narrow at certain points for mounts.

If Yellowknife is with the adventurers, the travel time through the pass is two days, otherwise it is three. To determine encounters, roll once from the table during the first day and roll twice from the table during the second and third days of travel.

Random Encounter table

d100	Result	d100	Result
01-05	Heavy Headwinds	46-55	Deadfall*
06-15	Narrow Ledge	56-75	Orc Scouts**
16-25	Deadfall	76-85	Lone Dire Wolf
26-35	Heavy Headwinds*	86-93	Snow Squall
36-45	Narrow Ledge*	94-00	Snow Squall*

*Roll an additional time from the table, using all results simultaneously for the encounter (reroll the additional roll if it is the same as a previous roll; consider Falling Snow and Snow Squall as the same in this case).

**Can only occur once. If this encounter is rolled more than once, reroll ignoring this result.

Deadfall

A layer of thin ice or snow hides a deadly drop. A successful DC 13 Wisdom (Perception) group check will notice the danger. If Yellowknife is with the group, modify to DC 10. A failed check results in the adventurer with the lowest individual check falling through the Deadfall. The adventurer must make a DC 10 Dexterity (Acrobatics) or DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check. Success means the adventurer stops themselves after a 10 foot fall and takes 1d6 bludgeoning damage. A failure means the adventurer falls 2d6 x 10 feet and takes 1d6 bludgeoning damage for every 10 feet. The DM should adjust for falling precautions taken, such as a rope chain between adventurers.

If an encounter takes place with a Deadfall present, the group check difficultly should be made by all combatant groups and is increased to DC 15. If a combatant falls through a Deadfall, it becomes apparent to everyone.

Heavy Headwinds

A corridor of the pass is consistently plagued by heavy headwinds that will not abate for 24 hours. The headwinds extinguish open flames, disperse fog, make magical flying almost impossible (must land or fall at end of turn), and can lead to exhaustion. If the adventurers decide to trek through the headwinds, they must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) check or take one level of exhaustion. Regardless of the results, adventurers that trek through the headwinds will get through them after an hour.

If an encounter takes place in Heavy Headwinds, there is disadvantage on ranged weapon attacks and Perception checks relying on hearing, and spell casters must make a Concentration check at the end of their turn for spells requiring Concentration.

Lone Dire Wolf

Wolves usually wander these mountains in packs, but some of the most dangerous are known to hunt alone. The lone **dire wolf** is near starving and will attack on sight, only fleeing if it is brought under 10 hit points.

Narrow Ledge

One wall of the pass falls away to reveal a drop with only a narrow ledge to navigate along. A successful DC 12 Dexterity (Acrobatics) check results in safe passage. If Yellowknife is with the group, modify to DC 10. A failed check requires a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check to grab hold, failure results in a fall from the ledge. The adventurer falls 2d6 x 10 feet and takes 1d6 bludgeoning damage for every 10 feet. The DM should adjust for falling precautions taken, such as a rope chain between adventurers.

If an encounter takes place with on a Narrow Ledge, the combatants can only fight in single file. If a combatant is hit during a combat round, at the end of the attacker's turn the defender must succeed on a DC 10 Dexterity (Acrobatics) or DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check or fall 2d6 x 10 feet, taking 1d6 bludgeoning damage for every 10 feet.

Orc Scouts

The adventurers stumble across a group of 1d4+1 Stonekin **Orc** scouts on their way down the mountain to spy on Trademoot. The orcs will attack on sight, giving no quarter and will fight to the death.

One of the orcs has a roughly sketched map of the vale beyond the mountains. A humanoid skull is crudely drawn over the symbol for Trademoot.

Encounters: Monster Stat Blocks

Unless otherwise indicated, use the Monster's Manual for monster stats. Stonekin orcs use the Orc stat block.

Snow Squall

Heavy snow breaks upon the pass creating blinding conditions for a day. If the adventurers attempt to travel in the snow squall, they must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom (Survival) check or gain one level of exhaustion. Adventurers without proper winter gear must make the check with Disadvantage. Also, the area is considered **heavily obscured** for the duration of the snow squall, blocking vision entirely. If an encounter takes place in a Snow Squall, combatants suffer the Blinded condition.

If Yellowknife is with the adventurers, she will recommend holing up until the snow squall passes.

Copper Mine

The Deepwound Pass ends at the entrance to the copper mine. The Ruined Rune clan of dwarves mined here while also building the watch tower. When they were driven away by the Stonekin orcs, gnomish artificers took to the mines in search of palladium. They departed once the

Copper Mine Features

The copper mine is composed of natural occurring limestone.

Ceilings. Thirty feet high unless otherwise indicated.

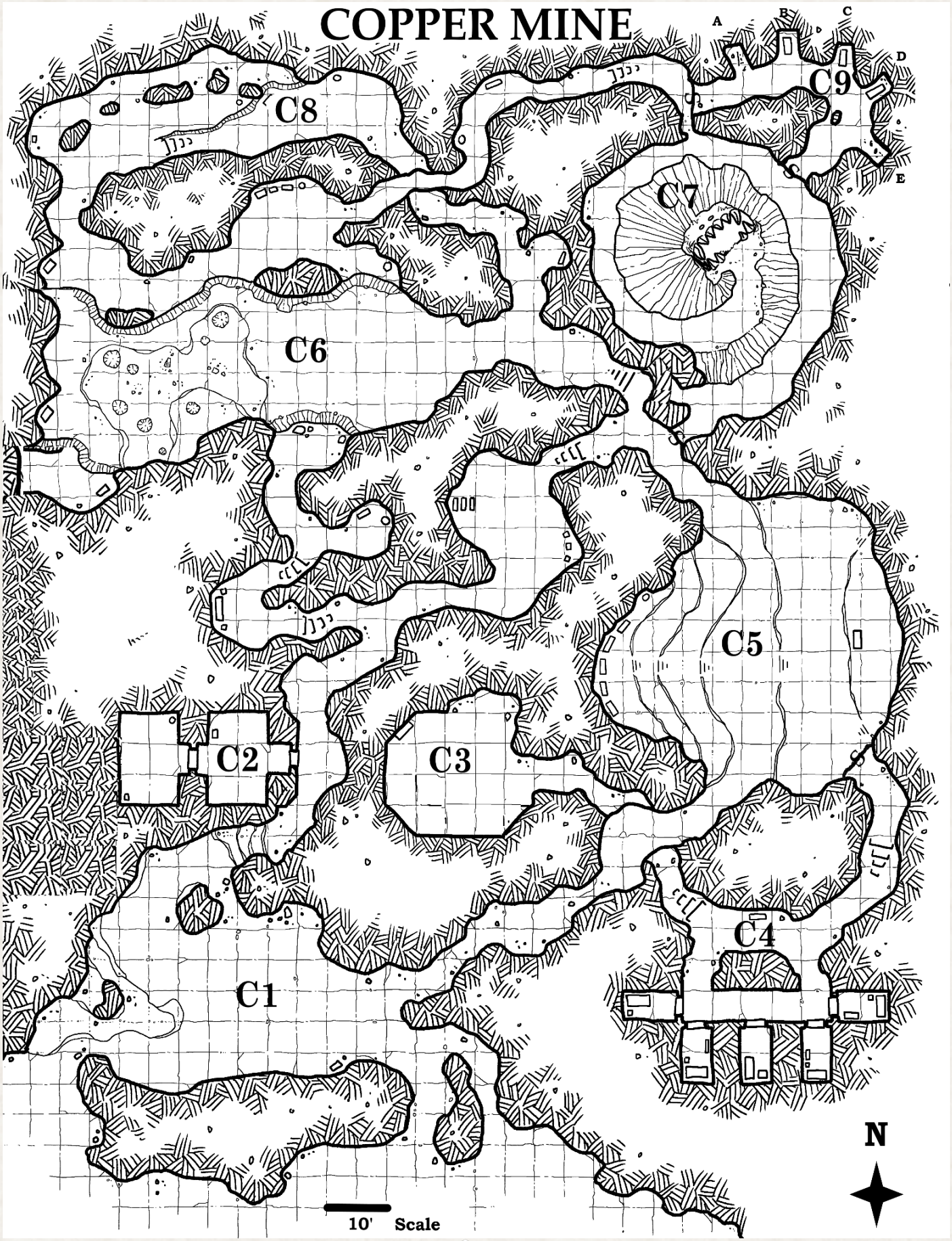
Doors. Doors are rusted and stuck closed, requiring a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check to pry open.

Five Senses. The mine's caves are pitch black with no natural light and as silent as the grave. A cross-breeze keeps the air fresh and cold, but the mine is otherwise unperturbed by outside elements.

Secret Doors. These are cleverly crafted sliding stone doors. A successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal a clue and a successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check will discover the opening mechanism. If a secret door is detected and opened, future checks are made with advantage.

Stairs. The stairs are roughly hewn from the rock floor in areas of natural incline/decline.

palladium was stripped, leaving the mine as it is found today.



C1-Entrance (Wolf Lair)

The mountain pass ends in a sheer cliff face with three cave openings. All three of the openings lead into the main entrance which is simply an open cave.

Recently, five wolves have taken residence in the cave. The wolves are all adults that broke away from the main pack and have been struggling to survive ever since. They are hungry and will attack anyone entering their lair.

The bones of an unfortunate orc caught by the wolves litter the cave. Scattered with the bones are 4 copper pieces and a dagger.

C2-Furnace Room

The walls and floor to this room have been carved into straight edges. Against the north and south walls of the room large dilapidated furnaces rest. A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check indicates that these are coal-fired furnaces used for copper smelting. A closed door is in the west of the room.

A successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal black smudges around the outer doorframe of the west door. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check of the west door will reveal that the smudges are caused by coal dust.

The second room holds copious piles of coal. If the west door is forced open, a cloud of coal dust will flood into the furnace room. If an open flame is within 10 feet of the doorway when this occurs, the coal dust will ignite causing an explosion. Adventurers within 15' of the doorway must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw. A failed save results in 2d6 fire damage, a successful save takes half damage.

Otherwise, there is nothing of interest in the rooms.

C3- Priest's Quarters

The dwarven mining and spiritual operations were led by a dwarven priest of Dumathoin. The priest's quarters have not been entered since the departure of the dwarves three centuries ago, and is just as it was left except for the coating of fine dust and rotted wood and cloth of the bed.

The room contains a bed, a standing wardrobe, and an iron chest. A successful DC 12 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal several minute holes drilled in the stone near the floor. A successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) check will reveal these as heat flutes running to a heat source (the furnaces in room C2).

The bed and wardrobe are both empty. The chest is locked and protected by a mechanical **poison needle trap**.

The chest contains a magic **Ruined Rune Medallion** and a faded piece of parchment with the script *'Fare thee well'* written in dwarvish.

Magic Item: Ruined Rune Medallion

Wondrous item, rare, attunement required

The medallion is attuned to the teleportation circle in areas A5 and the Ruined Rune Inn. To work properly, the medallion also must be attuned to the creature that possesses it.

When an attuned creature with the medallion in their possession steps in the teleportation circle, they can activate it by saying 'Fare thee well' in Dwarvish.

C4- Residences

These are quarters that housed the dwarven miners. The quarters have not been entered since the departure of the dwarves three centuries ago, and are just as they were left except for the coating of fine dust and rotted wood and cloth of the bed.

There is nothing of interest in these rooms.

C5- Temple of Dumathoin

This temple to the dwarven deity of mining and underground exploration was created with a much larger audience in mind than ever transpired in these failed mines.

A stone alter atop a raised stone dais at the east end of the chamber looks west over a large natural viewing area that slopes upward several levels, the seating areas of each level separated by narrow stone stairs.

There is a secret panel in the stone alter. The panel is locked and protected by a mechanical **dart trap**.

The panel chest contains the **Lantern of Runes** and a flask of oil.

Magic Item: Runesight Lantern

Wondrous item, uncommon

This item has the same properties and fuel requirements as a bullseye lantern. Additionally, the light from a Runesight lantern can reveal magically veiled runes (see areas C9-E and A5 for examples.

C6-Upper Mine

This room is cavernous, the natural rock glittering gold where light falls upon it. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check will reveal that the glittering shine in the wall is fool's gold. This check does not need to be repeated once the truth is determined.

Upper mine was not mined by the dwarves, but by the gnome artificers fifty years ago. As small scale as the dwarven operation was, the gnomish operation was even smaller and shorter lived. Only a few small areas of stone have been excavated.

If the adventurers investigate Upper Mine, they will determine that there are four small excavations in this area. A successful DC 17 Intelligence (Nature) check will reveal the presence of chalcopyrite, an ore mineral of copper, in abundance (the dwarves were driven away before they could mine this ore). The discovery indicates the possibility for future copper mining here.

There is nothing else of interest in this room.

C7-The Maw (Exit)

One side of the passage opens to reveal a darkened pit. The passage makes a slow circle around the pit, descending steadily towards the bottom. The air is colder here.

At the bottom of this area the passage ends at a large closed stone gate shaped like a maw with stone stalagmites and stalactites acting as teeth. There are a few inches between the teeth.

The maw can be opened by triggering the pressure plate in area C9-A. If opened this way, the maw will remain open for one hour before slowly closing again.

The stone teeth of the maw can also be destroyed to create gaps to wiggle through. There are six top teeth and four bottom teeth. Each tooth is AC 17, HP 27, and is resistant to piercing and slashing damage, and immune to poison and psychic damage. Destroying a tooth opens a one-foot wide and four-foot high gap in the maw.

Past the maw a passage climbs nearly 1000 feet in elevation over the course of a mile. The climb is considered Difficult Terrain. The passage exits at location A1 on the Avarsal map in Chapter 3.

C8-Lower Mine

This room is cavernous, the natural rock glittering gold where light falls upon it. A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Nature) check will reveal that the glittering shine in the wall is fool's gold. This check does not need to be repeated once the truth is determined.

At its base, the room is full of debris, and difficult to navigate through. The lower mine was excavated and mined by the dwarves three centuries ago, and all of the ore in this area has been depleted.

The stripped material was originally stored in Upper Mine, but that was all shoved into Lower Mine by the gnomes when they began excavations in the Upper Mine.

Lower Mine is considered difficult terrain. Investigating the room in its entirety will take several hours due to the debris. If the adventurers do so, each adventurer searching will have a 10% chance per hour to enter the proximity of a lost **Ring of Protection** buried under two feet of debris (per the spell, it is not detectable by Detect Magic due to shielding debris). Any adventurer that comes in proximity of the ring must succeed on a DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) check to find it. If an adventurer fails on this check, they must reroll the 10% to come into proximity of the ring again.

C9-The Five Alcoves

This secret passage has a stale smell to it as if the air has not been disturbed for a long time. Five alcoves branch from the north and west wall. The three inner alcoves each contain a locked iron chest. The two outer alcoves appear empty.

A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal smoothed stone above each of the alcove archways. The stone feels smooth to the touch and appears blank. However, there is a magically hidden rune written on each of the smooth areas that can be made visible by the light from the Runesight Lantern (see area C5). A **See Invisibility** spell will also work.

C9-A

The hidden rune above this alcove is in dwarvish and indicates 'Tower'.

The alcove has a pressure plate in the floor that requires 200 pounds to be triggered. When triggered, a heavy grating sound echoes from the south and the floor trembles as a mechanism hidden under the stone opens the Maw in area C7. The Maw will remain open for one hour before closing again. See area C7 for more details.

C9-B, C, D

The hidden rune above these alcoves is in dwarvish and indicates 'Danger'.

The iron chest in each of these alcoves is locked and double-trapped with a **poison needle trap** and **dart trap**. Treat the double-trap as one trap for the purpose of ability checks. If triggered, the poison needle trap and dart trap go off simultaneously. Once one of these alcove traps has been investigated, the others can be done so with Advantage.

The iron chest in area C contains 790 cp, 112 gp, and a **Scroll of Feather Fall**. The other iron chests are empty.

C9-E

The hidden rune above this alcove is in dwarvish and indicates 'Safe Haven'.

A damaged Ruined Rune teleportation circle is permanently chalked on the floor. It can only be seen by the light of a Runesight Lantern. The teleportation circle is non-operative and irreparable.

Copper Mine: Traps

All Traps.

- A successful DC 13 Intelligence (Investigation) check will discover the trap.
- If the trap is discovered, a successful DC 13 Dexterity check will disarm it.
- If the trap is associated with a lock, a creature proficient with Thieves' Tools can pick the lock with a successful DC 15 Dexterity check.
- Traps are triggered by normal means or if an attempt to disarm the trap results in a roll that fails the DC by five or more.

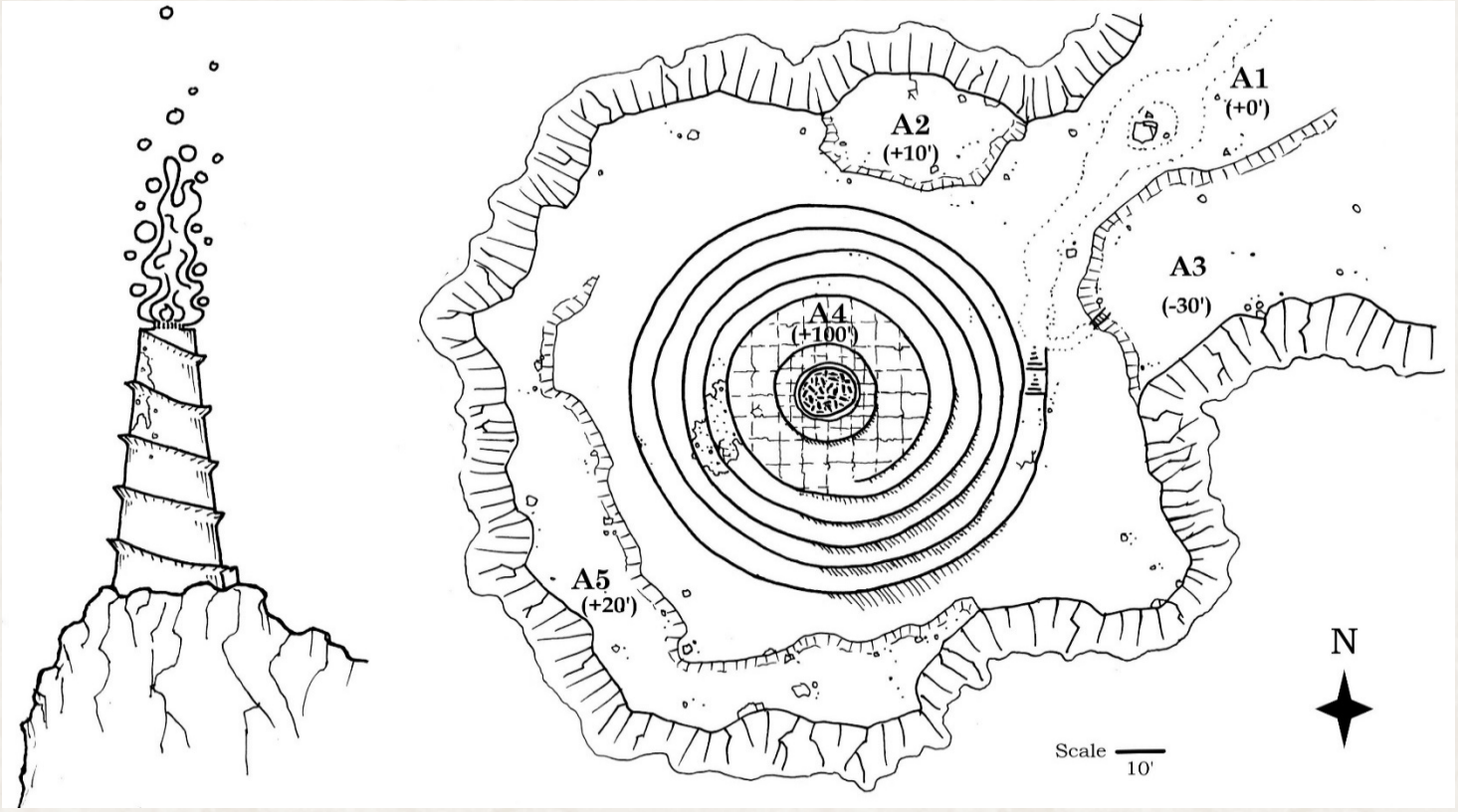
Poison Needle Trap. When this trap is triggered, the needle fires from the lock. The closest creature within line-of-sight and a five foot range takes 1 piercing damage and 1d12 poison damage, and must succeed on a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or be Poisoned for 2 hours. (The poison is stored in a protective glass tube and remains intact).

Dart Trap. When this trap is triggered, eight darts fire from various locations aimed at the trigger point. Each dart makes a ranged Attack with a +8 bonus against a random target within 10 feet of the trigger point (vision is irrelevant to this Attack roll). (If there are no Targets in the area, the darts don't hit anything.) A target that is hit takes 2 (1d4) piercing damage. The poison that accompanied the darts has long since degraded.

Chapter 3 – Avarsal

Read-Aloud Text

The passage opens looking west at a wind-stricken bluff. At the center of the bluff a stone watch tower stretches nearly a hundred feet high with a muted glow atop it. To your south, the path to the tower drops into a jagged valley. To the north of the tower, a ten-foot rise supports a cluster of boulders.



Recent Events at the Avarsal

Palladium the Construct. After Palladium the Construct (Aelwyn Avarsal's spirit) dispatched Erwen Erwell, she maintained her position atop the tower with the two Hammers of Helm in her grasp. Any attempt made to take the hammers has led to a quick and vicious rebuttal from Palladium. Otherwise, she has ignored all other occurrences due to her obsession with the glowing hammers.

Stonekin Orcs. Despite the fact that the Avarsal's light was extinguished from the sky, the Stonekin orcs became aware that there was still a small glow from atop of the tower. Intent on completely eradicating **Avarsal's Bane**, the orc tribe sent small groups to the top of the tower to fully extinguish the light. None of those orcs returned, as all were killed by Palladium the Construct. Unsure of the threat preventing them from succeeding (since there had been no survivors), the orcs decided to set up an advance camp as scouts (see area A2) and send a larger force to storm the tower and end the curse once and for all (the larger force is the orcs that can be spotted in area A3).

A1- Crossing

The passage after the maw in the Copper Mine (area C7) exits onto the northern edge of the Crossing.

The Crossing is a stone protrusion connecting the mountainside to the bluff proper. The north side ends abruptly in a 1000 foot fall down the mountainside. The south side is a steep fall into the Stonekin pass 30 feet below.

While at the center of the Crossing, a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal movement in Stonekin pass to the south (area A3). A successful DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation) check will reveal that the movement is a large contingent of orcs marching towards the Avarsal. The main body of the orc contingent that the adventurers can spot is still half a mile away, though there can be smaller advance groups closer than that, at the DM's discretion.

When nearing the southwest end of the Crossing, a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check will reveal bodies sprawled near the base of the tower. These are the bodies of Stonekin orcs thrown from the Avarsal tower by the construct.

Also when nearing the southwest end of the Crossing, a successful DC 17 Wisdom (Perception) check reveals movement among the rocky outcrop to the west (area A2). This movement is caused by the orc guards attempting to hide from the adventurers.

Landscape Features

Bluff. The bluff is a natural rocky outcrop jutting from the mountainside. It is reachable by the Crossing via the Copper Mine (A1) or Stonekin Pass (A3). The bluff is 6,000 feet above the tundra (where Trademoot sits) and 5,000 feet beneath the mountain peaks. The bluff drops sharply away with precipitous falls into the mountain crevices some 1,000+ feet below.

Five Senses. On a clear night, the sky is filled with glowing stars; during the day a beautiful vista of hills and valleys stretches to the horizon. There is a constant wind blowing down from the mountainside, bringing the cold with it. The air is notably thinner here than in Trademoot, but not thin enough to have an effect on the PCs.

A2- Orc Guards

This area is a 40 x 20 foot plateau rising 10 feet above the bluff. A contingent of eight advance **orc** guards waits at the top of this rocky outcrop for the main force of Stonekin orcs approaching from Stonekin Pass (A3).

The orcs will notice the approach of the adventurers on the Crossing (area A1) unless the adventurers take extraordinary precautions to hide their movement (such as an *invisibility* effect).

The orcs intend to ambush the adventurers and the boulders give them a Dexterity (Stealth) check of 17, which acts as the DC for a contested Wisdom (Perception) check by the adventurers.

The orcs will attack once the adventurers reach the west end of the Crossing (area A1), throwing spears from their position atop the plateau. They will attempt to draw the adventurers to them but if the adventurers do not advance, the orcs will charge.

> **Read-Aloud Text**
> With a guttural cry, a scattering of fur-clad orcs rise from their hidden position atop the western bluff, the wind snapping at their ragged capes. With monstrous strength, they hurl their javelins.

One of the orcs has a hunting horn which he will blow after the second round of the fight if he is still alive. The horn will alert the approaching force of trouble.

The orcs have 29 copper pieces among them.

A3- Stonekin Pass

Stonekin Pass is a windy, treacherous route through the mountains, dividing at certain points to lead either deep into orc territory or down to the mountain vale.

Stonekin Pass is not intended for the adventurers to explore as part of this adventure (except as a possible exit point at the end of the adventure, see the Conclusion section for more detail). Instead, it presents the avenue in which the unbeatable orc force approaches the Avarsal, creating the tension of impending doom and the necessity of quick action by the adventurers.

The DM has liberty to determine the nature of the approaching orc force, and if there are any small contingents in the lead that may have an opportunity to engage the adventurers if enough time passes.

The DM is encouraged to use the approach of the orc force, including the bray of horns and the howl of the orc cries on the wind as a compelling way to move the adventurers along to light the Avarsal.

A4- The Avarsal Tower

The Avarsal Tower is solid stone with no interior. It is 100 feet tall with a flat, circular landing at the top. The tower tapers inward so that the base of the tower has a diameter of 80 feet and the top of the tower has a diameter of 40 feet.

Tower Stairs

A stone staircase circles the exterior of the tower. The clever craftsmanship of the dwarves causes the stairs to blend in with the tower walls, and a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check is needed to spot them. The staircase circles the tower five times and has a total length of 945 feet. The vertical distance between each level of stairs is 20 feet. There are no railings and the stairs are 3 feet wide.

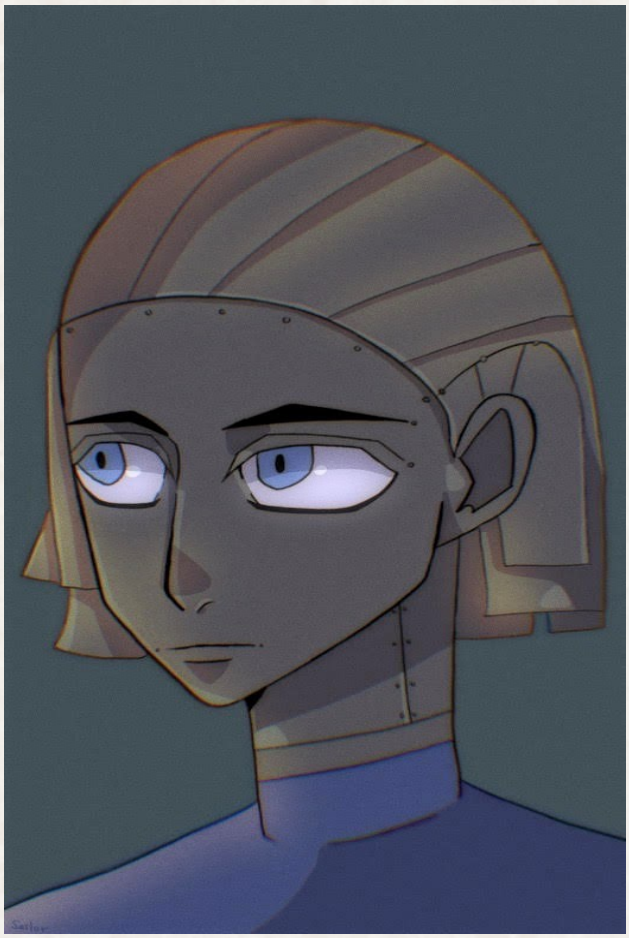
> **Climbing the Tower Stairs**
>
> **Difficult Terrain**. The stairs are considered Difficult Terrain.
>
> **Engaged.** If an adventurer is engaged in ranged or melee combat while on the stairs, they must succeed on a DC 10 Acrobatics check at the end of their turn to maintain their footing. If the PC fails their Acrobatics check, they must succeed on a DC 12 Athletics check or fall 20 feet down to the staircase below, taking 2d6 bludgeoning damage.
>
> **Whipping Wind.** An unpredictable wind scours the stairs of the Avarsal tower. While any creature is on the stairs, the wind can occur. At the end of the round, roll a 1d6. On a roll of a 6, the wind recharges and howls around the tower. Any creature on the stairs must succeed on a DC 12 Athletics check or fall 20 feet down to the staircase below, taking 2d6 bludgeoning damage.

Tower Top

The top of the tower is a flat, circular stone surface 40 feet in diameter. A circular shaft, 10 feet in diameter and 30 feet deep, is at its center. A rounded half-sphere of tempered glass, 15 feet in diameter, sits to the east of the shaft orifice. Two crank-and-chain pulley systems are set on the north and south side of the shaft orifice. On the west side of the shaft stands **Palladium the Construct** wielding both Hammers of Helm. The crushed corpses of three Stonekin orcs and Erwen Erwell are scattered near her feet.

> **The Avarsal**
>
> When the Avarsal is functioning properly, the light from the hammers strikes the diffraction glass to create a colorized beacon of light rising two miles into the sky.
>
> **Firepit Shaft**. The top of the tower was built with a 10 foot diameter x 30 foot deep hole at the center. In the time of the dwarves, this was filled with wood to create the watch tower flame. It was cleared out by the gnome artificers and retrofitted with the fixture (see below).
>
> **Fixture**. The fixture is an iron block that hangs near the bottom of the firepit by a chain and pulley system. The iron block has two cylindrical orifices that the shaft of each Hammer of Helm fits snugly into so that only the metal head of the hammer is visible resting at the top of iron block fixture.
>
> **Tempered Diffraction Glass**. The tempered diffraction glass is what makes the Avarsal glow so brightly. The parabola shape rests over the orifice of the firepit shaft and is kept in place by its weight (500 lbs). The glass was crafted by the artificers to be strong (it has the properties of steel due to the palladium) and to magnify and colorize the light from the glowing hammers.

Palladium the Construct



Read-Aloud Text

As you reach the top of the tower, a cold wind whips past you. The vista beyond the tower top is incredible--rocky mountains softening into rolling hills and silvered tundra that stretches to the horizon.

But that is mere backdrop to the strange scene closer at hand. A large crystalline structure shaped like the top half of an egg rests beside an open shaft leading down into the center of the tower. Pulleys sit on opposite sides of the shaft, holding fast two taut chains dropping into the unknown darkness.

Closer still, tattered cloth whips in the wind from four variously crushed bodies, three of them orcs.

Atop those, a palladium-and-bronze construct stretches nearly seven feet in height in the shape of a female warrior, her eyes sparkling with life. Two beautifully carved hammers are clutched in her hands, glowing with a bright, magical light.

The construct is **Palladium**, and the bodies are those of orcs who tried to wrest the hammers from her and of Erwen Erwell, who she struck down when defending herself against his attempt to get the hammers.

Other than preventing the Hammers of Helm from falling into other hands, Palladium has stood still since arriving with Erwen several days ago. She was used by Erwen to move the half-egg-shaped Diffraction Glass (see the Avarsal sidebar), to raise the Fixture, and to take the hammers for him, dousing the Avarsal light.

Palladium is possessed by Aelwyn Avarsal's spirit, and even though Aelwyn was good aligned in life, her spirit form has lost all memory and sense of good and evil, and she is only driven by the instinct to stay connected to the Hammers of Helm. For this reason, she will not release the hammers from her possession. Though she does not realize it, Aelwyn's spirit desires to leave Palladium and return to the hammers, which are her conduit to Helm's realm.

Palladium will become aware of any creature that crosses the threshold to the tower top and warn the transgressors to leave. If the warning goes unheeded, Palladium will attack.

The PCs may try to reason and/or persuade Palladium to cooperate. At the DM's discretion, such attempts may reveal the truth of Palladium's possession by Aelwyn's spirit, but they will not affect the construct's inability for self-realization and her intent to drive any intruders away.

Read-Aloud Text

The construct advances towards you, her heavy steps hammering the stone floor and crushing the scattered bones of her victims. Dispassionate except for the burn in her eyes, she raises the two glowing hammers in her hands, preparing to strike.

Palladium will attack until all creatures are driven off the top of the tower or until she is defeated. Use the NPC stats for **Palladium** in the NPC section.

The PCs can attempt to restart the Avarsal once Palladium is defeated or otherwise incapacitated.

Once the Avarsal is reactivated, the bright, colorful light will shine from the tower towards the heavens. The light is visible in daylight and darkness. Any Stonekin orcs in the vicinity will immediately be subject to the **Avarsal's Bane**.

Reactivating the Avarsal

Insert the Hammers. The hammers must be slid into the orifices of the iron fixture, which currently hangs by the chains of the pulley system about two feet from the top of the tower surface.

Lower the Fixture. Once the hammers are in place, their light will reflect upwards off the various mirrors attached to the fixture. The fixture then needs to be lowered to the bottom of the shaft, which can be done using the crank of each pulley in tandem. The descent takes three rounds. A successful DC 12 Strength (Athletics) check by each creature operating a pulley will result in a smooth, level descent. Failure results in the need to re-stabilize, extending the duration of the descent by three rounds. When the fixture reaches the bottom, the mirror fixtures at the bottom of the shaft will engage, throwing a stronger light up the shaft.

Replace the Diffraction Glass. Finally, the half-sphere of glass needs to be placed over the orifice of the shaft. The glass weighs 500 lbs, and can be dragged or lifted by using the rules governed by Strength in the Player's Handbook. The glass takes three rounds to put in place. Once this is in place, the full power of the Avarsal's light will emit.

A5- Ledge

Along the west and south sides of the bluff is a gently sloping ledge. The ledge rises 20 feet above the surface of the bluff, placing it at approximately the same height level as the first round of the tower stairs.

The ledge takes the brunt of the howling winds from the mountain tops. The winds are strong (21-30 mph) and considered Difficult Terrain.

A Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle is permanently chalked on a smooth portion of the ledge at the western end (see Magic Items section for details). The light of a Runesight Lanterns is needed to see the teleportation circle. Without this light, a Perception DC 17 check is needed to spot the purposefully smooth circular area (10 foot diameter).

Conclusion

How the adventure ends will largely depend on player decisions, strategies, and luck over the course of the various events. Thus the outcomes listed below are not meant to be the only possibilities for how the story ultimately unfolds, but rather a high level summary of the outcomes and details within these for consideration and guidance when reaching completion.

The Avarsal is Relit

In this scenario, the adventurers are successful in their endeavor to relight the Avarsal. This should have the intended effect of driving the Stonekin orcs back into the mountains with no intent on returning.

The council will be pleased with this outcome, rewarding the adventurers as promised. The council may provide additional rewards for information about the copper mine (especially the presence of copper), as well as the story behind how the Avarsal was extinguished and the details regarding how it was relit.

The Avarsal is Not Relit

In this scenario, the adventurers are not successful in their endeavor to relight the Avarsal. This can be due to circumstance or choice (if they choose to keep the Hammers of Helm for themselves, for example).

It is likely that in order to survive this scenario, the adventurers escaped the oncoming orcs, which means that the orc clan will be intent on attacking Trademoot. This leaves plenty of room for follow-up storylines and play, such as an invasion by the orcs, conflict over ownership of the Hammers of Helm, perhaps leading to another stand against the Stonekin orcs with the Hammers of Helm playing a part (if they are in the PCs or NPCs possession), or other possibilities.

Rewards/XP

- 400 gold pieces from the Trademoot Council for successfully relighting the Avarsal.
- 100 gold pieces from the Trademoot Council for useful information about the Avarsal.
- Milestone XP (optional): 2nd level upon successful completion of the Copper Mine, 3rd level upon successful completion of the adventure.

The Road Home Routes

The journey back to Trademoot is intended to be handled narratively, though that can be modified by the DM as desired.

Backtrack. The adventurers can return from the way they came. If Yellowknife is alive, she will waiting for the adventurers at the entrance to the Copper Mines.

Stonekin Pass. If the Avarsal is relit, the orc presence will be gone making this the most direct route down the mountains.

Teleportation Circle. If activated, the Teleportation Circle located in area A5 will safely send the adventurers to the destination Teleportation Circle in the Ruined Rune Inn.

Monsters & NPCs

"Palladium, don't make me do something you'll regret!"

—*Erwen Erwell,* moments before attacking Palladium

"I am not sensing any feelings of regret."

—*Palladium,* moments after slaying Erwen Erwell

Palladium the Construct

Palladium-Glass Construct, unaligned

Armor Class 17
Hit Points 45 (6d8+18)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	10 (+0)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Con +5, Str +5
Skills: Athletics +5
Damage Resistances cold, fire, lightning
Damage Immunities poison, psychic
Condition Immunities blinded, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages common, gnomish
Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Brute. A melee weapon deals one extra die of its damage when Palladium hits with it (included in the attack).

Actions

Hammer of Helm. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 16 (2d8 + 6) bludgeoning damage.

Abilities & Traits

Constructed Nature. Palladium doesn't require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Immutable Form. Palladium is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Wounded Fury: While Palladium has 10 hit points or fewer, she makes two melee attacks as an action.

Palladium's Backstory

Palladium is a prototype palladium-glass construct created by the gnome artificers nearly fifty years ago to function as their guardian and servant. The palladium-glass material comprising Palladium is a unique blend discovered by the gnomes which creates a material as tough as metal but with an opaque, glass-like surface.

When the gnome artificers departed from the settlement, a few stayed behind to continue their work and Palladium the Construct was left with them. As of a few days ago (until she killed him), Palladium was serving Erwen Erwell.

Palladium became possessed by Aelwyn Avarsal's spirit when the construct picked up the Hammers of Helm. Aelwyn did not intend to possess Palladium and knows only that she must remain in physical contact with the Hammers of Helm, which is why Palladium will not release them under any circumstance.

Magic Items

Hammers of Helm +1

Weapon, Very Rare

These hammers function as a pair. While both are wielded, you gain the following benefits:

- You can attack with one hammer and use the second hammer to parry as a free action, improving AC by 1.
- You cannot be Frightened.
- You gain the benefit of a Light cantrip with a permanent duration.

Avarsal's Bane. The hammers produce an ethereal flame visible in the material plane. Once an hour, any Stonekin orc (only this specific tribe) that can see the light must take the Blinded condition and make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw or take the Frightened condition. The conditions last one hour.

Ruined Rune Medallion

Wondrous item, Rare, Attunement Required

If you are in possession of this medallion and attune to it, you activate any Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle as a Free Action by coming with ten feet of it.

Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle

Wondrous item, Rare

If you are attuned to and in possession of a Ruined Rune Medallion, you will activate a Ruined Rune Teleportation Circle as a Free Action if you come within 10 feet of it.

Upon activation, a shimmering portal opens within the circle and remains open until the end of your next turn. Any creature that enters the portal and says 'Fare Thee Well' in dwarvish instantly appears within 5 feet of the destination circle located in Ruined Rune Inn basement or in the nearest unoccupied space if that space is occupied.

Runesight Lantern

Wondrous item, Uncommon

This item has the same properties and fuel requirements as a bullseye lantern.

- You can reveal magically veiled runes (see areas C9-E and A5 for examples) using the light from a Runesight Lantern.